

Da Lat & Nha Trang

8 - 12 September 2026

Haris Haikal & Aina Izzaty · flown Malaysia Airlines via Saigon · no driver to arrange
Hydrangeas are in season in Da Lat; Nha Trang is the driest corner of Vietnam this week.

The Five Days

DAY	DATE	WHERE	OUTFIT THEME	SLEEP
Day 1	Tue, 8 Sep	Fly in via Saigon, café evening	Soft blue + brown	Da Lat
Day 2	Wed, 9 Sep	Hydrangeas, flower park, farms	Soft pink + white · pm black leather	Da Lat
Day 3	Thu, 10 Sep	Fairytale Da Lat, then QL27C down	Cream fairytale	Move → Nha Trang
Day 4	Fri, 11 Sep	Cham towers, beach, islands	Blue + yellow	Nha Trang
Day 5	Sat, 12 Sep	Fly home via Saigon	Khaki + black	—

Book Tonight, In This Order

- 1 Ask Malaysia Airlines to reroute the CGK ticket to Saigon**
MAS flies KUL–Saigon ~7 times a day (MH750 / MH758 / MH766, ~2h). If they cancel Jakarta, ask to be moved to Saigon rather than refunded. **+60 3-7843-3000**
- 2 MAS: KUL → SGN on 8 Sept (morning) and SGN → KUL on 12 Sept (late afternoon)**
Leave yourself three hours on each side for the domestic connection.
- 3 Domestic: SGN → Da Lat on 8 Sept, Cam Ranh → SGN on 12 Sept**
Vietnam Airlines or Vietjet. SGN–DLI 55 min, 6 a day, last 17:30. CXR–SGN 1h05, 7 a day.
- 4 Or check the AirAsia directs first**
KUL → Da Lat (AK571, 2h10) and Cam Ranh → KUL both run ~4 days a week. If 8 and 12 Sept are operating days, that's two flights instead of four.
- 5 Hotels: 2 nights Da Lat (8-9), 2 nights Nha Trang (10-11)**
Da Lat: near Xuan Huong Lake or the centre. Nha Trang: on the Tran Phu beachfront, bay view.
- 6 Private car, Da Lat → Nha Trang on 10 Sept**
Specify **QL27C**, the 135 km mountain route, and a pickup around 13.30.
- 7 Cancel or move the Bandung bookings**
Holiday Inn Pasteur, Swiss-Belresort Dago, Fairfield CGK — ask for a waiver citing the airport closure. Message Kiki.
- 8 Insurance, eSIM, offline maps**
Re-issue the insurance for Vietnam; keep the Bandung paperwork for the claim.

Good To Know

Visa Visa-free for Malaysians, 30 days. Carry hotel bookings and onward tickets.	Money Vietnamese dong. Cards fine in both cities; cash for markets and flower farms.	Getting around Grab and Xanh SM in Da Lat and Nha Trang. Only the mountain crossing needs a booked car.
Two climates Da Lat 17–24°C, cool nights, afternoon rain. Nha Trang 28–32°C and dry. Pack for both.	Saigon connection Domestic is T1, international T2. On separate tickets you re-check bags — allow 3 hours.	If you fly on the 9th Drop Day 1: land in Da Lat that evening, fold the flowers and the fairytale into the 10th, drive down on the 11th, fly home the 12th. Three nights, same six themes.

MAS out: _____ SGN → DLI: _____ CXR → SGN: _____ MAS home: _____
 Da Lat hotel: _____ Nha Trang hotel: _____ QL27C car: _____ *Checked 6 Sept 2026.*

DAY 1

KUL → Saigon → Da Lat

Tuesday, 8 September

START
Morning MAS out of KLIA

FINISH
~21.00

SLEEP
Da Lat (nights 1-2)

Outfit: Soft blue + brown — café theme, for the first Da Lat evening

TIME	WHERE	HOW LONG	NOTES
morning	KUL → SGN — Malaysia Airlines KLIA	~2h	MH750 / MH758 / MH766 — about 7 a day, so pick one landing in Saigon by early afternoon. Vietnam is 1 hour behind Malaysia .
~12.30	Connect at Tan Son Nhat Saigon — international T2, domestic T1	~3h	On separate tickets you must collect your bags, walk to T1 and check in again . Allow three hours; it is a short walk but the queues are not.
~15.30	SGN → DLI — Vietnam Airlines or Vietjet Tan Son Nhat T1	55 min	Six a day, last one 17:30. Book this the same day as the MAS leg so a delay doesn't strand you.
Lien Khuong airport → Da Lat city — 30 km, ~40 min			
~17.30	Check in — Da Lat Da Lat city	1h	Da Lat sits at 1,500 m: 17-24°C, the coolest part of the trip. Jacket out of the bag tonight.
~19.00	Evening café + dinner Da Lat centre	2h	An Cafe, Still Cafe or La Viet Coffee — wood, warm light, mountain air. This is the soft-blue-and-brown evening.

NOTES FOR THE DAY

- Long travel day but no long road transfer, unlike the Bandung and Sapa versions.
- **Simpler alternative:** AirAsia flies KUL → Da Lat direct (AK571, 2h10) — but only ~4 days a week, so check whether 8 September is one of them. If it is, take it and skip the Saigon connection entirely.
- Grab works in Da Lat. Book the airport car through the hotel if you land after dark.

DAY 2

Flower day — hydrangeas and the farms

Wednesday, 9 September

START
08.30FINISH
~21.00SLEEP
Da Lat (night 2)
Outfit: Soft pink + white all day · evening switch to **black leather + white** for the night market

TIME	WHERE	HOW LONG	NOTES
08.30	Trai Mat hydrangea field (cắm tú cầu) Trai Mat, ~7 km east of the centre Open in Google Maps	2h	Two hectares of hydrangeas down a hillside — blue, violet and pink. In season now: they flower May to December. Go early for soft light and an empty field.
~10 min			
~10.45	Linh Phuoc Pagoda Trai Mat Open in Google Maps	1h	The mosaic dragon temple — built from broken pottery and glass. Right next to the hydrangeas, so it costs you nothing to add.
~12.15	Lunch in town Da Lat centre	1h	
~13.45	Da Lat Flower Park (Vườn hoa thành phố) By Xuan Huong Lake Open in Google Maps	1.5h	The city's permanent flower garden by the lake — beds replanted year-round, which is why September still works here.
~15 min			
~15.45	A greenhouse flower farm + the market flower street Da Lat outskirts / Cho Da Lat	1.5h	Da Lat grows most of Vietnam's cut flowers under glass. Ask the hotel which farm is currently open to visitors — they rotate.
~17.30	Back to the hotel, change	1h	Swap into the black leather and white — evenings here drop to 17–19°C, the one place on this trip cold enough for it.
~19.00	Da Lat Night Market + a pine-forest café Cho Dem, city centre Open in Google Maps	2h	Grilled corn, banh trang nuong, hot soy milk. The night market stairs are the classic Da Lat photo.

NOTES FOR THE DAY

- **Gardens in the morning.** September is Da Lat's wettest month and the rain is an afternoon and evening habit — front-load anything outdoors.
- Light rain shell in the day bag, always. It passes in bursts, then clears.
- Flower farms are working businesses; some charge a small entry, some want you to buy a bunch. Both are fine.

DAY 3

Fairytale morning, then the mountain road to the sea

Thursday, 10 September

START 08.00	FINISH ~20.30	SLEEP Move → Nha Trang (nights 3–4)
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Outfit: Cream fairytale — the storybook buildings are the backdrop

TIME	WHERE	HOW LONG	NOTES
08.00	Crazy House (Hàng Nga Guesthouse) Huynh Thuc Khang, Da Lat Open in Google Maps	1h	The tree-and-cave house — the single most fairytale building in Vietnam. Go at opening; the stairs are narrow and it jams up by ten.
~10 min			
~09.30	Da Lat Railway Station Quang Trung, Da Lat Open in Google Maps	1h	1930s art-deco station in yellow and cream, with the old cog railway carriages. The cream outfit was made for this one.
~10 min			
~11.00	Domaine de Marie church + Da Lat Palace grounds Da Lat Open in Google Maps	1h	Pink-washed convent church and the colonial-era palace lawns. Quiet, and quietly grand.
~12.15	Lunch + checkout Da Lat	1.5h	Bags in the car before you eat — the driver picks you up from the restaurant.
DRIVE: Da Lat → Nha Trang on QL27C — 135 km, ~3h05			
~17.15	Check in — Nha Trang Tran Phu beachfront	1h	You've dropped from 1,500 m to sea level: 28–32°C now. Jacket back in the bag for good.
~19.00	Seafood dinner by the water Nha Trang Open in Google Maps	1.5h	

NOTES FOR THE DAY

- **Take QL27C, not QL27B.** 135 km and ~3 hours through pine forest and the Khanh Le pass, against 179 km and ~4 hours the other way. It is one of the best drives in Vietnam — ask the driver to stop at the pass.
- Book a private car the day before. Grab does not do this route properly.
- Leave Da Lat by 13.30 so you cross the pass in daylight.

DAY 4

Nha Trang — the dry day

Friday, 11 September

START
08.00

FINISH
~21.00

SLEEP
Nha Trang (night 4)

Outfit: Blue + yellow — sea, sand, and Po Nagar's ochre brick

TIME	WHERE	HOW LONG	NOTES
08.00	Po Nagar Cham Towers Hai Thang Tu, north of the river Open in Google Maps	1.5h	Eighth-century Cham brick towers on a hill above the river — deep ochre and gold against the sky. Blue and yellow against that brick is the shot of the day. Shoulders covered inside.
~15 min			
~10.00	Hon Chong Promontory North Nha Trang Open in Google Maps	1h	Stacked granite boulders over the bay, with the islands behind. Short stop, big view.
~11.30	Beach time — Tran Phu beachfront Nha Trang city beach	1.5h	Six kilometres of sand right in front of the city. Loungers are cheap; the water is calm this side of October.
~13.00	Seafood lunch Nha Trang Open in Google Maps	1h	
~14.30	Island boat trip <i>or</i> the Vinpearl cable car Cau Da pier / Vinpearl Open in Google Maps	3h	Pick one. The boat visits Hon Mun and Hon Tam for snorkelling; the cable car runs three kilometres over the sea to the island resort. Both are weather-dependent — decide in the morning.
~17.45	Sunset on the beach Tran Phu	1h	Nha Trang faces east, so sunset lights the mountains behind you rather than the sea. Still the best hour of the day.
~19.30	Dinner + pack Nha Trang	1.5h	

NOTES FOR THE DAY

- **This is the dry half of the trip.** Nha Trang has the shortest rainy season in Vietnam and roughly 300 sunny days a year — its wet season doesn't start until October.
- Hot and humid, 28–32°C. Sunscreen matters more here than anywhere else on the trip.
- Everything today is 10–20 minutes apart by Grab.

DAY 5

Fly home — Nha Trang → Saigon → KUL

Saturday, 12 September

START 08.00	FINISH KUL	SLEEP —
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Outfit: Khaki + black — travel day

TIME	WHERE	HOW LONG	NOTES
08.00	Breakfast + last beach walk Nha Trang	1.5h	
Nha Trang → Cam Ranh airport (CXR) — 35-40 km, ~45 min			
~10.15	Checkout → Cam Ranh airport Cam Ranh (CXR)	—	The airport is well south of the city — leave more time than the distance suggests.
~12.00	CXR → SGN — Vietnam Airlines or Vietjet Cam Ranh	1h 05m	Seven a day, from 04:00 to 21:50, so there's plenty of choice to fit the MAS leg.
~14.00	Connect at Tan Son Nhat Saigon — domestic T1 → international T2	~3h	Same drill in reverse: collect bags at T1, walk to T2, check in for MAS.
late afternoon	SGN → KUL — Malaysia Airlines Tan Son Nhat T2	~2h	MH750 / MH758 / MH766 again. Malaysia is 1 hour ahead, so you land later on the clock than the flight time suggests.

NOTES FOR THE DAY

- **Simpler alternative:** AirAsia flies Cam Ranh → KUL direct — about 4 days a week. If 12 September is one, it saves you the whole Saigon connection.
- Book the two domestic legs and the two MAS legs as one itinerary if any agent will do it — otherwise a delay on the domestic hop is your problem, not the airline's.